UPFRONT

NATIONAL SAMPLE SURVEY

THE HEALTH GAINS AND GAPS

The National Sample Survey's 80th round on household social consumption–health shows a mixed picture: stronger maternal care and insurance coverage alongside rising illness reporting, high treatment costs and a continued reliance on private healthcare

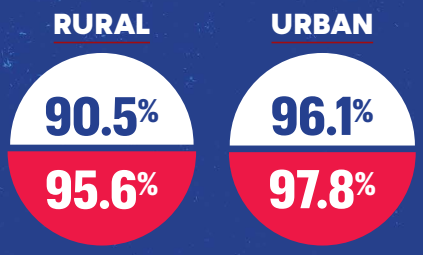
Text by **SONALI ACHARJEE**
Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

MATERNAL GAINS

Maternal healthcare access is now near universal, reflecting major public health progress

Institutional deliveries

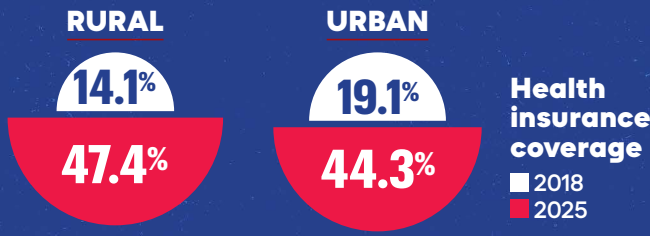
2018 2025



98% **Pregnant women who received antenatal care in previous 365 days** (2025)

INSURANCE SURGE

Health insurance coverage has expanded rapidly, especially in rural areas, driven by public schemes

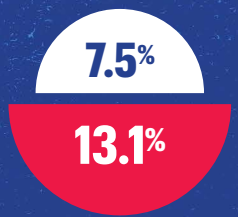


ILLNESS RISE

A sharp increase in illness reporting highlights a mix of growing disease burden and better awareness/ detection

Population reporting illness in previous 15 days

2018 2025

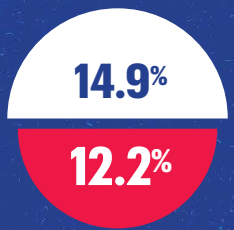


URBAN SKEW

Urban residents report higher illness rates, reflecting both better access to diagnosis and lifestyle-related risks

Population reporting illness in previous 15 days (2025)

Urban Rural



SENIOR BURDEN

Illness is concentrated among older Indians, signalling rising age-related healthcare demand

Population aged 60+ who reported illness in previous 15 days (2025)

